

Chord accompaniment

Another way of creating a more complete sound for a melody is to accompany it with chords, either on a piano, guitar, or ukulele. The chord names are printed above the melody. This style of melodic accompaniment notation is frequently used in jazz or pop music.

▽ Chord symbols

These symbols give the name of the root, the chord quality, and any note above the root added to the chord (identified by the size of the interval, such as 7 or 9).

A musical score for the hymn "Amazing Grace" in 3/4 time, key of B-flat major. The melody is written on a single staff with lyrics underneath. Chord symbols are placed above the notes: F (first measure), Bb (second measure), F (third measure), C7 (fourth measure), F (fifth measure), Bb (sixth measure), F (seventh measure), C7 (eighth measure), F (ninth measure), Bb (tenth measure), F (eleventh measure), and Bb (twelfth measure). The lyrics are: "A - maz - ing grace! (how sweet the sound) That saved a wretch like Me! I once was lost, but now am found, Was blind, but now I see. 'Twas grace that taught my heart to

Multiple instruments

Two lines or voices are easily depicted on the grand staff. For more than two, composers use a full score. The example here shows what a piano trio score looks like. Each instrument has its own staff, perfectly aligned with the others.

▽ Schubert's *Trio in E-flat Major*

This is the opening of the first movement, an Allegro in sonata form, of Franz Schubert's *Second Piano Trio, Op. 100* (1827).

A musical score for the opening of Schubert's *Trio in E-flat Major*, Op. 100, No. 1. The score is in 3/4 time, key of E-flat major, and marked "Allegro". It features three staves: Violin (treble clef), Cello (bass clef), and Piano (grand staff with treble and bass clefs). The tempo is "Allegro". The score shows the first four measures. Annotations include: "The melody is depicted here in the treble clef staff, played by the violin." (pointing to the Violin staff), "The melody is doubled by the cello, two octaves lower, and is shown on its own staff." (pointing to the Cello staff), "The piano also plays the melody, but doubled at the octave in both hands." (pointing to the Piano grand staff), "All instruments rest at the same time, for two counts. This can be read easily because all the parts are aligned in the score." (pointing to the rests in the first measure), and "The piano staff has two lines—treble and bass clef." (pointing to the Piano grand staff).